DONG, Cai (/dɔŋ, tsaɪ/;"Cyra"; 董猜)

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EDUCATION

Yonsei University Seoul, South Korea

B.A. in Philosophy, Interdisciplinary Major in Cognitive Science, Minor in Applied Statistics, March 2023 - Expected June 2027

GPA: 3.59/4.3. Relevant coursework: Brain Imaging Data Analysis (A+), Calculus I–III, Linear Algebra, Statistical Methods, Mathematical Statistics I (Received B in Spring 2026; F on transcript due to sickness attendance rule), R Programming, Information Theory for Data Science, Reinforcement Learning, Visual Cognitive Neuroscience, General Biology, 18 credits in Linguistics

Washington University in St. Louis St. Louis, MO

Exchange Student in Arts & Sciences, Jan. 2025 – Jun. 2025

GPA: 3.75/4.0. Coursework in linguistics, statistics, cognitive science, and speech&hearing science.

MGH Institute of Health Professions Boston, MA / Online

Online prerequisite coursework in Speech-Language Pathology, May 2025 – Aug. 2025

GPA: 4.0/4.0. Coursework: Anatomy & Physiology of Speech and Hearing Mechanisms; Introduction to Chemistry.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Jinri (진리) Merit-Based Tuition Scholarship, Yonsei University; awarded for two terms.
- National Second Prize, Peking University Chinese Literature Competition, 2018.
- Fully funded exchange student at Washington University in St. Louis through Yonsei University exchange nomination.

RESEARCH STATEMENT

A researcher working between first-person experience and third-person measurement, asking what each can reveal that the other cannot.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Dong, C**., & ten Brink, M, . et al. (2026). sleepcleanr: an auditable pipeline for cleaning self-reported sleep-diary data, validated on injected, real and public data. *Manuscript in preparation for Behavior Research Methods.*
- **Dong, C**., Lin, T., et al. (2026). Multimodal AI scoring of facilitative interpersonal skills: a replication and specification audit on Tele-FIRST trial recordings. *Manuscript in preparation for Psychotherapy Research.*
- **Dong, C.,** Li, M., Chen, S. (2026). When the Instrument Is the Result: Test–Retest Noise Floors for LLM Readouts of Code-Switched Narratives. *Under review, ACL Rolling Review (October 2026); commitment-eligible for NAACL 2027 / COLING 2027.*
- Huo, R., Yang, S., **Dong, C.,** Chen, S. (2026). Underestimation of others' attitudes toward AI: Implications for AI adoption. *Journal of Applied Social Psychology, 56(6), 443–456. https://doi.org/10.1111/jasp.70063*
- Huo, R., Yang, S., **Dong, C.,** Chen, S. (2024). Perceived economic inequality inhibits pro-environmental engagement. *British Journal of Social Psychology, 64(2), e12815. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjso.12815*
- Dong, C. (2023). Hume's aesthetic thoughts and modern art. *SHS Web of Conferences, 174, 02022. https://doi.org/10.1051/shsconf/202317402022*

CONFERENCE POSTERS & PRESENTATIONS

- Hwang, H.Y., **Dong, C.,** Jeong, S.Y., & Kim, J.E. (2026). Regulatory T cells: Mechanisms and therapeutic potential in tumor microenvironment. Poster presented at STEM Union Academic Conference 2026, Seoul, South Korea. *(Hosted by AYUI, Yonsei Univ.) (Contributed to figure editing, translation, and introduction & discussion writing)*
- **Dong, C**., Dayan, C., Barcroft, J., & Sommers, M. (2026). Auditory and visual cue integration in L1 vocabulary learning. *Poster to be presented at the end of 2026(Project currently on hold.)*
- Lin, T., Wiley, J., Zhu, Y., **Dong, C**., Tang, M., Taylor, D. J., Pruiksma, K. E., Feler, B., Kautz, M., Baker, J., Khazem, L., Bryan, C. J., & Brown, L. A. (2025). Predicting next-day suicidal urges, depression, and PTSD symptoms using ecological momentary assessments and passive sensing of sleep among military service members. *Poster presented at the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (ABCT) Annual Convention.*
- **Dong, C.,** & Au, A. (2024). Effects of neural fatigue from speech perception in noise on social withdrawal: Evidence from fNIRS hyperscanning experiments. *Poster presented at the Brain and Mind Institute, Chinese University of Hong Kong, China.*

ACADEMIC & CAMPUS ENGAGEMENT

- Association of Yonsei Undergraduate Immunologists (AYUI) · Member & Research Contributor; March 2026 – January 2027
- The Secret Book Society · Member & Event Organizer; English Literature & Wine Tasting, Yonsei University
- "Poop Club" (똥동아리) —Member and poetry/creative-writing contributor; Yonsei University & inter-university consortium

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Aarhus University & Cambridge Psychiatry, Embodied Computation Group Aarhus, Danmark / Remote

Research Intern; PI: Micah Allen, Ph.D. October 2026 – Present

- Developing research on large language models (LLMs), interoception, and consciousness.

Shanghai AI Laboratory Shanghai, China / Remote

AI4BioSci / SciForge Research Assistant; PI: Zhangyang Gao, Ph.D. May 2026 – Present

- Integrated DeepSeek Harness as a third agent runtime into SciForge; contributed 28 PRs across a 6,000+ case automated test suite.
- Designed an evidence-provenance and human-oversight framework for SciForge; evaluated graph-based review policies on 200 held-out graphs, finding belief-greedy outperformed learned GNN/REINFORCE policies (1.14 vs. 1.56 sink errors). Repo

Stanford University, Stanford Psychophysiology Lab Stanford, CA / Remote

Research Assistant; PIs: James Gross, Ph.D.; mentored by Maia ten Brink, Ph.D., Oct. 2025 – Present

- Built SleepCleanr, a CI-tested R package for cleaning 10,000+ EMA/sleep diary records — parses timestamps, detects AM/PM and temporal order errors, computes sleep metrics (TST/SOL/WASO/SE), and generates 27 QC figures with a human-in-the-loop CSV audit trail. Preparing extensive technical documentation for SleepCleanr and drafting academic methodology sections.
- Synthesized literature on interoception, psychophysiology, and emotion dynamics.

Penn Medicine Psychiatry, University of Pennsylvania Philadelphia, PA / Remote

Research Intern, mentored by Tao Lin, Ph.D., Nov. 2025 – Apr. 2026, Sept. 2026 – Present

- Built a leakage-safe Python pipeline for multimodal AI scoring of facilitative interpersonal skills (FIS) — 2,171 therapist responses, 153 therapists, teletherapy RCT — with rebuild-verified data provenance.
- Replicated and extended Aafjes-van Doorn et al.'s (2025, *Psychotherapy*) multimodal FIS scoring, fixing the original's flagged clip-nesting confound; primary-analysis transcript predictions reached Spearman $\rho = .61$ [.56, .66] with participant-wise nested CV.
- Training slowed speech rate (waitlist-controlled); self-ratings were inflated versus observer scores while AI scores were unbiased (Truth-and-Bias model); manuscript in preparation for Psychotherapy Research.

Yonsei University, Clinical Neuroscience of Anxiety and Depression Lab (CAD) Seoul, South Korea

Research Assistant; PI: Juyoen Hur, Ph.D., May 2026 – Present

- Assisting clinical and affective neuroscience research on anxiety, depression, and related vulnerability mechanisms; reviewing fMRI, statistical modeling, and machine-learning materials for clinical neuroscience research.
- Performed fMRI data quality assurance, including motion check, artifact detection, and preprocessing pipeline validation.
- Independent project on misophonia, investigating sensory registration versus affective appraisal using clinical and trial-level data.

Zhejiang University of Science and Technology, Social Psychology Lab Hangzhou, China / Remote

Long-Term Research Contributor; PI: Sijing Chen, Ph.D., Jul. 2023 – Jun. 2026

- Conducted R/Python analyses (regression, mediation, effect-size estimation, Chinese Social Survey data) supporting two peer-reviewed publications (BJSP; JASP) and theory development.

Washington University in St. Louis, Speech & Hearing Lab St. Louis, MO / Remote

Research Assistant; PIs: Mitchell Sommers, Ph.D., Joe Barcroft, Ph.D., Jan. 2025 – Jun. 2026

- Built IPA-based coding scheme to quantify lexical difficulty, defining a 30% phonemic-overlap gradient across English words; contributed to L1 vocabulary-learning experiment design assessing auditory-visual cue integration.
- Recorded, curated, and denoised experimental audio stimuli; assisted participant testing and R-based statistical validation.

Sanhua Holding Group, Digital AI Department Hangzhou, China

CLINICAL, MENTORSHIP & COMMUNITY EXPERIENCE

Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities Research Center, Washington University School of Medicine St. Louis, MO

Clinical Observation, Jul. 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Observed psychotherapy sessions, intake evaluations, and ADOS/testing procedures in a clinical research setting.

Central Institute for the Deaf, Washington University School of Medicine St. Louis, MO

Clinical Shadowing; Teacher Aide and Recreation Aide, May 2025 – Jun. 2025

- Shadowed family sessions and toddler language-intervention classes; supported speech-language pathologists, educators, and audiologists in multilingual auditory-oral learning contexts.

Artists First St. Louis, MO

Therapeutic Art Program Volunteer, Jun. 2025 – Jul. 2025

- Supported therapeutic art sessions promoting self-expression, social interaction, and emotional regulation.

Beijing Normal University, Department of Psychology Beijing, China / Remote

Volunteer Editor, Clinical Psychology Content, Jun. 2024 – Sep. 2024

- Compiled 80+ clinical psychology entries for Baidu Encyclopedia to improve Mandarin-language professional resources.

Educational Mentorship & Sponsorship Initiative China / Korea

Mentor, 2021 – 2025

- Mentored a student from a rural, low-income background in university admissions, helping them gain admission to Hanyang University through sustained academic guidance and financial support.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

R, Python, MATLAB, Git/GitHub; EMA; multimodal analysis; pupillometry preprocessing; fMRI quality control; PsychoPy; fNIRS

LANGUAGES & TEACHING

Mandarin Chinese: native. English: IELTS 8.0. Korean: TOPIK Level 6. Japanese: JLPT N2.

Real-time Korean–English medical interpreter, The Peak Clinic (더피크의원) dermatology clinic, *Nov. 2026 – Present; Seoul, Korea.*

Taught Korean (one year, 2024) and Chinese (six months, ongoing).

HOBBIES

Literature and creative writing; Yoga; Contemporary Art; Guzheng(Traditional Chinese Plucked Zither)

CERTIFICATES

Autism and Neurodiversity in the Childcare Setting, CIRCA, University of British Columbia.